

CRAIG ALLEN POTTS

Lewisburg, TN

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Portfolio/GitHub: <https://linktr.ee/allenpotts13>

SUMMARY

Data Engineer with a strong production and operations background, transitioning from 14 years in IT support and infrastructure roles. Experienced in building and maintaining reliable data pipelines using Python and SQL, with hands-on work across cloud platforms including AWS and Azure. Skilled in ETL/ELT development, relational data modeling, orchestration, and data quality validation. Known for clear documentation, operational discipline, and end-to-end ownership of systems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages:

Python, SQL, Java

Data & Analytics:

PostgreSQL, Microsoft SQL Server, Snowflake, Databricks, DuckDB, dbt

Cloud Platforms:

AWS (S3, Lambda, DynamoDB, CloudFormation, CloudWatch)

Azure (Functions, Blob Storage)

Data Engineering Concepts:

ETL/ELT pipelines, data modeling, data validation, schema management, orchestration, batch processing, basic streaming concepts

Tools & Frameworks:

Apache Airflow, FastAPI, Docker, Git, GitHub, CI/CD

Data Integration:

REST APIs, CSV/JSON ingestion, SFTP, web scraping, pub-sub concepts

EXPERIENCE

Nashville Software School — Data Engineer Apprentice

May 2025 – September 2025

- Designed and implemented data pipelines ingesting CSV, JSON, REST API, and SFTP sources into Snowflake and PostgreSQL.
 - Built raw-to-cleaned transformation layers using SQL and dbt-style modeling practices.
 - Orchestrated scheduled workflows using Apache Airflow, including dependency management and failure handling.
 - Implemented Python-based data validation checks to detect schema drift, missing fields, and data quality issues.
 - Developed and deployed FastAPI services to expose and integrate data across Microsoft SQL Server and Snowflake.
 - Explored event-driven and near real-time ingestion patterns using Kafka and pub-sub concepts.
 - Automated pipeline execution and testing using GitHub-based CI/CD workflows.
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Nashville Software School — Software Engineer Apprentice (Java / AWS)

March 2022 – December 2022

- Built backend services using Java and AWS services, including Lambda, DynamoDB, RDS, S3, and CloudFormation.
 - Implemented RESTful APIs and business logic with a focus on maintainability and testability.
 - Wrote unit and integration tests using JUnit and Mockito to validate application behavior.
 - Practiced object-oriented design, dependency injection, and debugging of production-like systems.
 - Collaborated in Agile Scrum teams using Git and GitHub for version control and code reviews.
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First Horizon Bank — IT Support Specialist Sr

August 2018 – Present

- Supported production systems across geographically distributed branch locations, resolving incidents under SLA constraints.
 - Diagnosed and troubleshoot complex workstation, network, and application issues using structured root cause analysis.
 - Followed formal Change, Incident, and Problem Management processes to maintain system stability and auditability.
 - Created and maintained internal documentation and knowledgebase articles to standardize resolutions and reduce repeat incidents.
 - Coordinated with external vendors and internal teams to deploy fixes, upgrades, and site-level improvements.
 - Assisted with testing and rollout of new tools, processes, and system changes in production environments.
 - Managed competing priorities in a fast-paced environment while maintaining operational accuracy and customer satisfaction.
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Systems & Methods, Inc. — LAN Administrator

September 2012 – August 2018

- Maintained LAN and WAN environments, virtual machines, and on-prem infrastructure across multiple locations.
 - Monitored server room health, network connectivity, and security systems.
 - Created and maintained technical documentation for network topology and system configurations.
 - Provided remote support for users and systems across multiple states.
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PROJECTS

Motorcycle Crash Data and Statistics

- Built a fully automated data pipeline using Python and Apache Airflow 3.
- Ingested data from FTP and web sources into S3-compatible object storage.
- Utilized DuckDB for analytical querying and transformation.
- Implemented data cleaning and transformation logic to support downstream analytics.
- Built Metabase dashboards on top of the lakehouse architecture for reporting and visualization.

GitHub: <https://github.com/allenpotts13/data-engineering-capstone>

TrueAchievements Group Service

- Built a multi-user achievement tracking service using AWS Cognito, Lambda, DynamoDB, and CloudFront.
- Designed secure authentication flows and backend APIs.
- Modeled data and implemented group dashboards for user activity tracking.

GitHub: https://github.com/nsscystone_trueachievements

EDUCATION

Nashville Software School — Data Engineering

Completed September 2025

Nashville Software School — Software Engineering

Completed December 2023

Kaplan University — Associate of Science, Information Technology

Graduated January 2013

GPA: 4.0

Western Governors University — Accelerated Bachelor's/Master's, Computer Science

Estimated Graduation: June 2028
